

Signs You Might Need Help

Stress vs. Mental Health Conditions

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What is stress

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Mental health conditions: What to watch for

Mental health conditions like anxiety, depression, trauma, or grief often mimic stress. But these conditions go deeper and may require professional support.



Common signs of stress

- Feeling overwhelmed or anxious
- Trouble concentrating or making decisions
- Frequent headaches or muscle tension
- Irritability or mood swings
- Sleep disturbances (insomnia or oversleeping)

Common signs of mental health conditions:

- Persistent sadness or hopelessness
- Withdrawal from social interactions
- Excessive worry or fear that doesn't subside
- Difficulty in functioning at work or home
- Suicidal thoughts or self-harm

How to Tell the Difference

It can be hard to distinguish stress from a mental health condition, but here are a few guidelines to help:

- **Duration:** Stress is usually linked to a specific event and tends to go away once the situation resolves. Mental health issues are ongoing and may persist without a clear cause.
- **Impact:** Mental health conditions significantly impact daily life, making it hard to function normally.
- **Physical symptoms:** Chronic stress may manifest as headaches or muscle tension, while mental health conditions often cause fatigue, sleep issues, and appetite changes.

When to Seek Help

If you're unsure whether you're dealing with stress or something more, consider these key moments when seeking help is essential:

- Your symptoms have persisted for more than a few weeks.
- You feel like you're losing control or can't cope.
- Friends or family have expressed concern.
- You've noticed changes in your behavior, mood, or energy levels.

Where to Get Help:

- **Counseling or therapy:** A mental health professional can help you identify underlying issues and develop coping strategies.
- **Support groups:** Connecting with others can provide comfort and perspective.
- **Self-care practices:** Journaling, mindfulness, and regular exercise can reduce stress and improve mental health.



For more resources, visit our website or contact a local mental health professional. Remember, asking for help is a sign of strength, not weakness.

